

NOTION PROJECT MANAGEMENT EXPERIENCE UI REDESIGN

WAYPOINT

Know the work. Move it forward.

Project Type	Advanced UI/UX Redesign
Reference Product	Notion
Primary Tool	Figma
Implementation	React + TypeScript + Vite + Tailwind CSS
Target Platform	Desktop Web — 1440 × 1024

1. Executive Summary

This project presents an original redesign of Notion's project-management experience. The redesign preserves the strengths of a flexible workspace—pages, modular content, databases and collaboration—while introducing a clearer project-management information architecture.

The central goal is to help project teams understand what needs attention, what is progressing, what is overdue, who owns the work, and what happens next without requiring unnecessary navigation.

Core improvements

- Clearer project health visibility
- Focused task management
- Stronger deadline and milestone visibility
- Dedicated Kanban workflow
- Timeline/Gantt-style planning
- Team workload visibility
- Centralized files and activity
- Faster quick-add actions
- Search and filtering
- Purposeful light and dark themes
- Reusable UI components

2. Project Objective

The academic project calls for a modern project-management interface focused on visual clarity, task management and team collaboration. The redesign translates those requirements into a connected product experience rather than isolated screens.

Primary objective: Make project-critical information easier to see, understand and act upon while retaining the flexibility associated with a Notion-style workspace.

3. Existing Product Reference

Notion is used as the reference product because its flexible workspace model combines pages, databases, documentation and collaboration. This project does not attempt to reproduce Notion's interface or branding. Instead, it uses the reference experience to identify opportunities around project health, task discoverability, deadlines, ownership, workload, milestones and dependencies.

These observations are treated as design opportunities rather than universal claims about Notion's usability.

4. Redesign Strategy

Preserve

Flexible workspace thinking • Rich content • Databases • Collaboration • Modular information • Customizable project spaces

Improve

Project visibility • Task discoverability • Deadline awareness • Progress tracking • Team workload visibility • Navigation • Milestones • Dependencies • Files • Activity • Quick actions

Design principle

Notion's flexibility + dedicated project-management clarity. The navigation shifts toward an active-work mental model: What needs attention → What am I working on → What is due → Which project → Who owns it.

5. Information Architecture

WAYPOINT
■■■ Overview
■■■ My Tasks
■■■ Projects
■■■ Calendar
■■■ Timeline
■■■ Team
■■■ Files
■■■ Favorites
■■■ Recent
■■■ Settings
■■■ Help
■■■ Profile

The persistent sidebar provides orientation, while the top bar contains breadcrumb, page title, global search, Quick Add, notifications and profile.

6. User Flow

Overview → Projects → Project Home → Tasks → Task Details → Timeline / Calendar → Team / Files / Activity

Example task workflow: Dashboard → Upcoming Task → Task Details → Edit Status / Priority / Assignee → Update Checklist → Add Comment → Task Progress Updated.

7. Screen Architecture

7.1 Overview Dashboard

Project health, upcoming work, today's tasks, overdue work, workload, progress metrics and recent activity. The dashboard answers what requires attention right now.

7.2 Projects

Grid/list views with search, filters, sorting, project health, progress, deadlines, owners, teams and task counts.

7.3 Project Home

A single source of truth containing description, status, progress, deadline, owner, members, milestones, risks/blockers and activity. Tabs: Overview, Tasks, Timeline, Files and Activity.

7.4 Task Management / Kanban

Backlog, To Do, In Progress, In Review and Done. Cards show title, priority, assignee, due date, tags, checklist progress, comments and attachments. Drag-and-drop and quick creation are supported.

7.5 Task Details

Focused detail view containing title, description, project, status, priority, assignee, due date, tags, checklist, attachments, comments, activity and dependencies.

7.6 Timeline / Gantt

Project phases with start/end dates, progress, milestones, dependencies and current-date indicator.

7.7 Calendar

Month, Week and Agenda views for tasks, deadlines and milestones.

7.8 Team / Workload

Member identity, role, active tasks, completed tasks, workload and availability, with access to assigned work.

7.9 Files

Centralized files with search, filtering, sorting, upload and project grouping.

7.10 Notifications & Settings

Notifications include All, Unread and Mentions. Settings include Profile, Workspace, Notifications, Appearance and Security.

8. Design System

Typography

Primary UI typeface: Inter. Styles include Display, H1–H4, Body, Body Small, Caption, Label and Button.

Color strategy

A neutral foundation is paired with a restrained primary accent. Green communicates completed/healthy/success; amber communicates attention; red communicates overdue/blocked/error; indigo communicates active/selected/in progress.

Reusable components

Buttons, icon buttons, inputs, search, selects, dropdowns, tabs, badges, avatars, progress bars, task cards, project cards, tables, modals, drawers, toasts, checkboxes, date pickers, sidebar, top bar, timeline, calendar and dedicated empty/loading/error states.

9. Interaction & State Design

The interface includes hover, focus, active, disabled, loading, empty, success and error states. Quick actions include New Project, Add Task, Add Member and Upload File.

Empty: No projects found. Try adjusting your search or filters.

Success: Task updated successfully.

Error: Unable to save changes. Please try again.

10. Light & Dark Mode

Light mode uses neutral backgrounds, light surfaces, strong primary text, muted secondary text, subtle borders and restrained accents. Dark mode uses deep charcoal backgrounds, slightly lighter surfaces, subtle borders, adjusted semantic colors and strong contrast. Dark mode is designed intentionally rather than simply inverted. Priority dark-mode screens are the Overview Dashboard and Kanban Board.

11. Accessibility

Accessibility considerations include semantic HTML, keyboard-friendly controls, visible focus states, accessible labels, ARIA labels for icon-only controls, sufficient contrast, readable typography and logical interaction order.

12. Technical Implementation

The working prototype is planned as a modern frontend application using React, TypeScript, Vite, Tailwind CSS, React Router, Lucide React, Recharts and LocalStorage.

```
src/  
■■■ components/  
■■■ pages/  
■■■ layouts/  
■■■ hooks/  
■■■ data/  
■■■ types/  
■■■ utils/  
■■■ styles/
```

The architecture separates UI components, data, application logic, types and utilities for reuse and maintainability.

13. Data Model

Structured models are used for Project, Task, User, Milestone, Comment, Attachment, Notification, Activity and Dependency. The prototype uses fictional data only. LocalStorage provides persistence for the frontend demonstration.

14. Key UX Improvements

Project health: Status, progress, deadlines and blockers are surfaced together.

Active-work navigation: Primary navigation emphasizes current work.

Dedicated task workflow: Status, priority, ownership, deadline and progress are visible in one workflow.

Milestones and dependencies: Project sequencing receives dedicated visual treatment.

Team workload: Ownership and capacity are easier to scan.

Centralized context: Tasks, files, activity, milestones and team information connect through the project.

Faster actions: Quick-add controls reduce friction.

15. Visual Design Principles

01 — Clarity over decoration: Every visual element should help the user understand or act.

02 — Information hierarchy: Important information appears before secondary details.

03 — Consistency: Repeated interactions use predictable patterns.

04 — Context: Tasks retain project, ownership and deadline context.

05 — Progressive disclosure: Detailed information appears when needed.

06 — Calm productivity: The interface remains focused, professional and purposeful.

16. Evaluation Against the Brief

Requirement	Design Response
Desktop-first	1440 × 1024 target
Project dashboard	Overview Dashboard
Task management	Kanban board
Project details	Project Home
Calendar / timeline	Calendar + Timeline
Team views	Team / Workload
Attachments	Files + Task Attachments
Deadlines	Dashboard, tasks, projects and calendar
Progress tracking	Project and task progress
Light / dark mode	Both themes
Sidebar navigation	Persistent sidebar
Project switcher	Workspace/project switcher
Cards / tables / tabs	Used throughout
Status badges	Semantic status system
Checklists / tags	Task metadata
Search / filters	Projects, tasks, files and global search
Empty / success / error	Dedicated UI states

Requirement	Design Response
Dependencies	Timeline + Task Details
Collaboration	Comments, activity and assignments
Quick add	New Project / Add Task / Add Member
Editable states	Task and project editing
Drag and drop	Kanban workflow

17. Testing Plan

Before final submission, test navigation, task creation/editing/deletion, Kanban drag-and-drop, search, filtering, sorting, checklist updates, comments, notifications, calendar, timeline, theme switching, LocalStorage persistence, empty states, success/error feedback, desktop layout consistency and dark-mode contrast. Test the deployed version separately from local development.

18. Deliverables

Figma: Research, redesign analysis, user flow, low-fidelity wireframes, design system, high-fidelity UI, light mode, dark mode and interactive prototype.

Working application: Source code, functional navigation, project/task workflows, timeline, calendar, team views, files, theme switching and responsive behavior.

Documentation: Detailed report, screenshots, design rationale, UX decisions and testing notes.

Presentation: Short project walkthrough / feedback video.

19. Submission Links

GitHub Repository: INSERT GITHUB URL

Detailed Project Report: INSERT REPORT URL

Deployed Application: INSERT DEPLOYMENT URL

Project Feedback Video: INSERT VIDEO URL

Figma — View Only: INSERT FIGMA URL

20. Conclusion

WAYPOINT rethinks the project-management experience around one central principle: **Make the work easier to see, understand and move forward.** The redesign preserves the flexibility associated with Notion while introducing stronger structure around project execution. Project health, tasks, deadlines, milestones, ownership, workload, files and collaboration are connected through a clearer information architecture.

Appendix — Recommended Final Screenshots

1. Overview Dashboard
2. Projects
3. Project Home
4. Kanban Board
5. Task Details
6. Timeline
7. Calendar
8. Team / Workload
9. Files

- 10. Dark Mode Dashboard
- 11. Dark Mode Kanban
- 12. Interactive Prototype